



Joining the Pack - Software Engineering Intern

We're thrilled you're interested in Datadog! This guide is for you to get a better idea of what to expect throughout the interview process, as well as what it's like to work here.

If you require specific accommodations due to a disability, please submit [this form](#), and our team will be happy to assist.

Inception of Datadog

Our founders, Olivier Pomel and Alexis Lê-Quôc, met in school and went on to work together as software engineers at IBM Research. Years later, they were both at Amplify (formerly Wireless Generation), where Olivier led the development team and Alexis led the operations team. They wanted to build a more collaborative system that brought their teams together, so they founded Datadog in 2010.

Datadog Today

Datadog is the leading observability and security platform for the AI era. We give businesses unified visibility across the technology stack so they can manage complexity at scale, bringing applications, infrastructure, data, models, and security into one place and using AI to detect and resolve issues before they impact customers. Our customers range from Fortune 500 companies to high-growth AI leaders.

As a valued member of Datadog's engineering department, you will help build and maintain our best-of-breed software. Depending on your role, you may help our team create a new technology integration, architect new patterns for Datadog infrastructure, or introduce intuitive features to better address customer needs. You will work alongside AI coding tools as you do it, so we look for people who already use them or are keen to learn how to use them well, and who are curious about how AI can improve both engineering practices and the products we build.

Our product is built by engineers, for engineers. Because of that, dogfooding is at the heart of everything we do. Our software engineers use Datadog's products extensively to test, evaluate, and refine them in order to build cutting-edge solutions for our customers.

850+
Integrations

We run on
millions of hosts

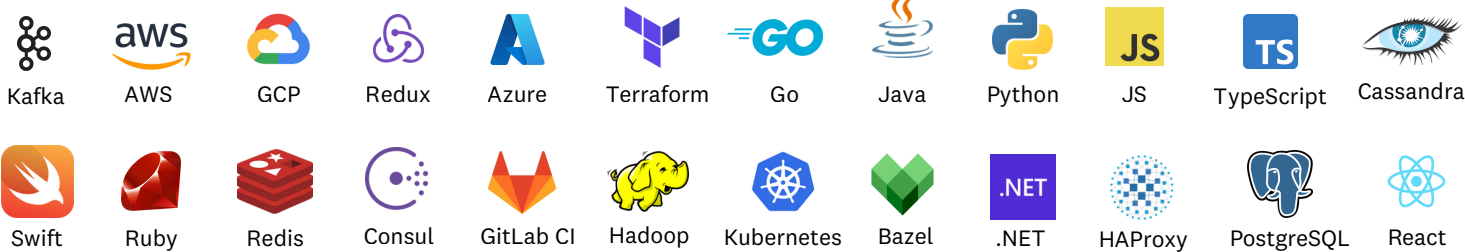
~30,500
Customers

Named a Leader in the
2025 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™
for Observability Platforms

8,100+ Datadogs
globally across
35 countries



Tech Stack



Engineering Values

- Ownership: knows their systems inside and out, feels responsible, has the plan for the next 5 things to make the system better
- Excellence: deep, precise, and current understanding of their technical area
- Pragmatism: cuts through ambiguity to get real solutions, ships code, prefers simple solutions with boring, well-hardened technology
- Honesty: tells you when they don't know the answer, admits what went wrong in what they built before
- Humility: not arrogant, respects the challenge of the work and the contribution of the whole team, knows they have more to learn
- Enthusiasm: excited about Datadog, about technology, excited to be here working with us
- Friendliness: the sort of person you'd be excited to work together with on a problem

Datadog Early Careers

[Learn more >](#)

Women Building Datadog

[Learn more >](#)

This Month in Datadog

[Learn more >](#)

Student Developer Pack

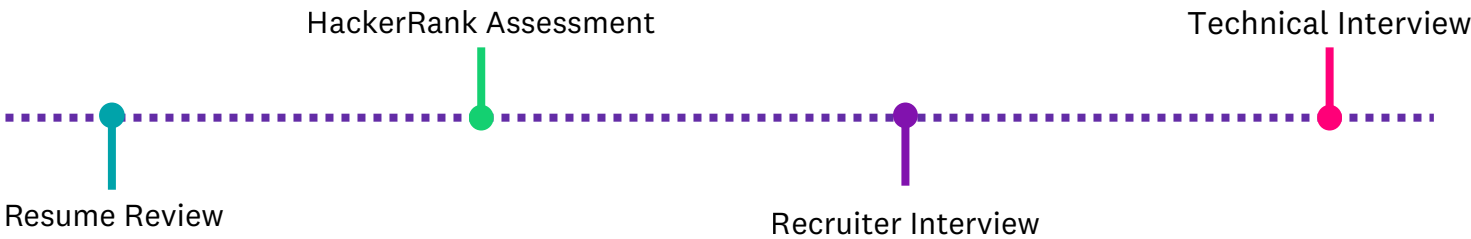
[Learn more >](#)



Our Recruiting Process

The recruiting process will span over a couple of weeks and will consist of three main steps. You will have two main points of contact during the process, your recruiter and your coordinator. Your coordinator manages scheduling your interviews, while your recruiter is the best resource for anything else!

If you have competing deadlines with other companies, please let your recruiter know. While we do our best to keep you updated, don't hesitate to email us to get an update on your application.



Interview Prep

Please consider the environment where you'll be taking your interview — ensure you have:

- A good signal, whether that's Wi-Fi or cell
- A quiet environment that allows you to hear and be heard correctly
- Any notifications snoozed to minimize distractions
- Tested audio, video, and are comfortable using [Zoom](#) and Remote Code

HackerRank Assessment

Datadog uses the technology platform HackerRank to help us objectively evaluate tech talent and streamline our application process. Your coordinator will send you an email through the HackerRank platform, inviting you to complete the coding assignment. The test consists of 2 coding problems focused on computer science fundamentals. Start the assessment when you can dedicate your undivided attention to it for 60 minutes, as it must be completed within that timeframe. Your deadline will be listed in the invite, but we greatly appreciate you completing the assessment within one week.

Once you complete the test, our team will automatically be notified. We will get back to you within a week to let you know if we are able to move forward to the next step, the recruiter interview.

Tips

- Create an account on the platform using the same email address as the one used to apply to Datadog. Otherwise, you may encounter an error.
- You can complete the questions in the programming language of your choice, and you can choose different languages for each question if you wish.
- We recommend you go through a practice test on HackerRank before attempting the assignment in order to get a handle on the platform. You can practice various HackerRank assessments [here](#) and review [our HackerRank prep guide](#).
- If you require additional time to complete the HackerRank assessment, please let your coordinator know.

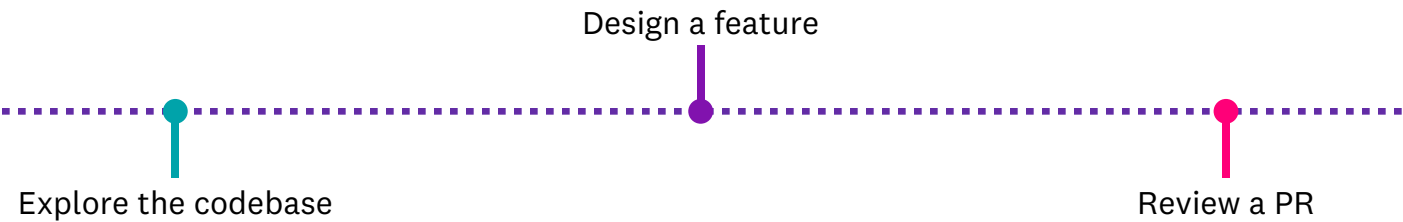
Recruiter Interview

You'll have an interview with one of our campus recruiters, so we can learn more about your experience and you as a person. Your recruiter will also be happy to answer any general questions you may have about Datadog and the role.

Technical Interview

A Datadog engineer will lead this interview, which will last 1 hour and 30 minutes. This interview begins with a discussion about your background, a project you've worked on, and your career interests. Following this, we move to the coding portion, which consists of three phases. First, you will explore an unfamiliar codebase for a web app. Second, you will be asked to design a new feature and you will explain your approach - no need for a whiteboard, we'll talk through the design choices at a high level. Finally, you will be asked to do a small code review of a PR built on the same codebase.

You can complete the exercise in whichever of these languages you know best: Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, Go, C, C++, Kotlin, or Rust. If your strongest language isn't listed, pick the next best option in the list. Be prepared to move through the three phases of the interview - your interviewer will partner with you to pace the interview. We highly recommend studying API design beforehand.





What we’re evaluating

This interview mirrors how engineers actually work at Datadog: getting oriented in unfamiliar code, designing new functionality, and reviewing work for correctness before it ships. We’re not just looking for the right answer at each stage. We want to see how you think through problems, how you communicate your reasoning, and how you ask for and use help when you get stuck.

- When you’re dropped into a codebase or language you don’t know, how do you get oriented?
- When you spot an issue or edge case, how do you verify it’s actually a problem, and how do you communicate it (and its impact) to others?
- How do you check both correctness (does it work) and completeness (does it do what was actually requested)?

Tips for the interview

- **Project discussion:** Choose a project that shows your technical skills and your ability to work with others.
- **Think out loud:** Ask clarifying questions, confirm your assumptions, and communicate your approach as you go. Clear, structured communication throughout the exercise is extremely valuable.
- **It’s OK not to know everything:** We’re looking to find your strengths rather than focusing on your weaknesses. We value humility. If you’re stuck, say where and why - your interviewer is there to help! Adapt your approach based on their feedback and coaching.
- **Come with questions:** You’ll have time at the end of the interview to ask the interviewer anything. Come prepared with questions about what you want to know about Datadog!
- **Prep in advance:** [Review our interview prep resources before your session.](#)
- **Brush up on these topics:**
 - Practical, self-contained programming problems - no algorithm memorization required
 - Working with data structures like maps, lists, and sets
 - Coding best practices
 - Testing (edge case testing, unit, etc.)
 - [REST API design](#)
 - Reading someone else’s code and understanding how data moves through it
 - Structuring small backend services or endpoints
 - Writing and running tests against existing code

Interview Tools

Zoom

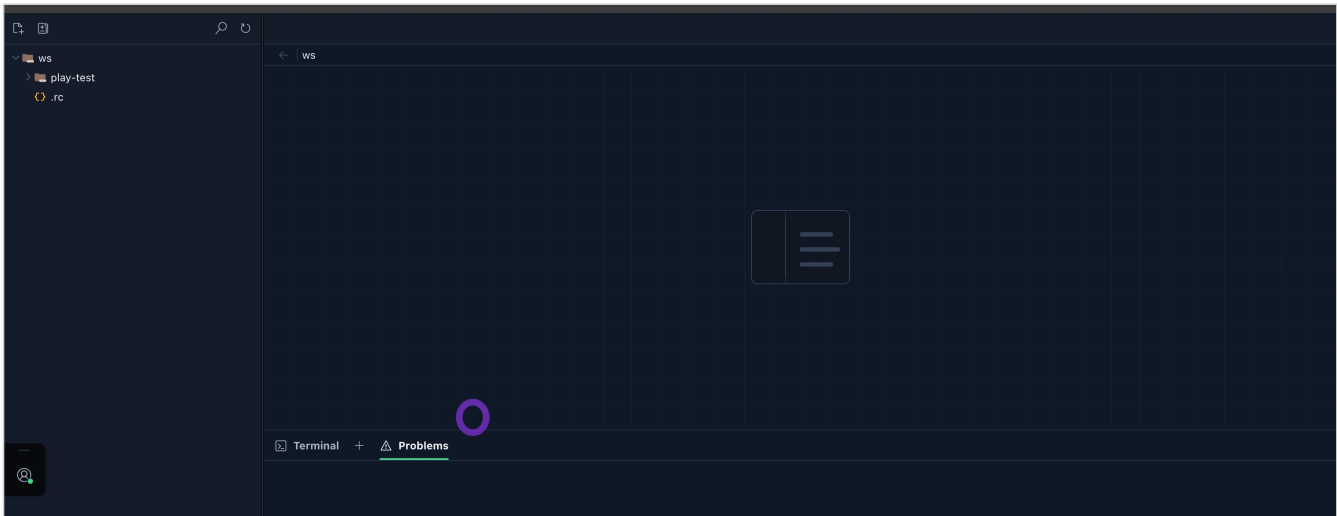
You can log in to Zoom using the link from your interview invite. A prompt will appear to download Zoom from that link, but feel free to opt out and use the browser setting if you would prefer not to download the application. We suggest testing it before the interview to ensure audio and video are working. If you prefer your phone over your laptop, please make sure you’ve tested it out prior to your interview to work out any kinks with headphones, microphones, or connection.

Please consider the environment you’ll be taking your call in - ensure you have:

- A good signal, whether that’s Wi-Fi or cell
- A quiet environment that allows you to hear and be heard correctly
- Any notifications snoozed to minimize distractions
- A place you feel comfortable spending a few hours, with access to whatever you might need during that time (computer, phone, charging, snacks, restroom, etc.)

Remote Code

We use Remote Code, our internal coding environment, for interviews - the interviewer will give you a link when you join the call. See the Remote Code Platform Guide on the next page for a full walkthrough of the environment before your interview.





What is Remote Code?

Remote Code is a cloud-hosted VS Code environment built for technical interviews. It runs entirely in your browser, with a real terminal, file explorer, and editor ready to go. Your interviewer can see your editor, cursor, and open tabs in real time once you share your screen.

Joining the session

- Open the URL in your browser (Chrome recommended). You will see a short code, and the interviewer will review the pending request and approve you to join the session.
- You will appear in the editor highlighted in blue, and your interviewer appears in red.
- Please share your screen during the interview so we can see what files you open, notes you take, etc.

The editor

The environment is similar to a full VS Code workspace. You will have access to:

- **File explorer:** browse, create, and search project files
- **Editor tabs:** open multiple files, cmd-click to find references
- **Diff viewer:** changes to files (additions, deletions)
- **Terminal:** full bash shell at the bottom of the screen

Recommended Attire

We have no dress code for our interviews. Feel free to wear what makes you feel comfortable and confident. Most people tend to default to business casual, but note that your interviewers and recruiter will likely be wearing a t-shirt. Ultimately, we don't care what you wear, and it won't affect how we assess your performance in interviews.

Team Assignment

All candidates go through the same interview process to be a software engineering intern at Datadog. In your recruiter interview, you will discuss your preferences (frontend, backend, security, data engineering, etc.), as well as any other preference you may have. Typically, candidates are hired without a team assignment. We note your preferences/experience and align that with our available opportunities 1-2 months before your start date. Then, we will introduce you to your team before your first day, so you can learn about the problems you'll be solving.

Feedback

We are constantly iterating on our processes to ensure we're providing a good candidate experience, so please feel free to share any feedback you have with your recruiter!

Diversity, Equity & Inclusion

At Datadog, diversity means making a conscious effort to reflect the many experiences and identities of the world outside, while treating each other with fairness and without bias. Inclusion is the choice we make every day to foster an environment where people of all backgrounds not only belong but excel, so that together, as a company, we can succeed. [Learn more about DEI at Datadog here.](#)

Making an Impact Together

We're dedicated to building a more inclusive company and working constantly to improve our practices, foster diverse teams, and impact greater communities. We know that we cannot singlehandedly build strong teams without cultivating meaningful relationships with other organizations. Some of our initiatives and partners include:



Inclusion Training



Allyship Training



Giving Programs



Inclusive Benefits



Mentorship Program



Educational Scholarships

Community Presence



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